

Paragraph:

Pulse is a vital sign defined as the rhythmic expansion of the arteries resulting from the heartbeat, and it is used to measure heart rate in beats per minute (bpm). In adults, a normal resting pulse typically ranges from 60 to 100 bpm, although trained athletes may have lower values between 40 and 60 bpm due to increased cardiovascular efficiency. Abnormal pulse rates include tachycardia (elevated heart rate) and bradycardia (reduced heart rate), as well as irregular or bounding pulses, which may indicate underlying cardiovascular problems or physiological stress. In a triage setting, pulse is used as a rapid indicator of a patient's circulatory status, where abnormal findings can signal serious conditions such as shock or acute illness. Therefore, accurate pulse assessment is essential for prioritising patient care and guiding immediate clinical decisions.

Reference:

MedlinePlus. (2016). Pulse. National Library of Medicine.
<https://medlineplus.gov/ency/article/003399.htm>